



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – TFC Emilee Shackleford #875

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 5 - Dalton

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00159712

Related Crash Reports: C000934442 ; C000929430 ; _____

P.I.T. Involved: Yes

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: Yes

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 02/5/2024

Time: 1416 Hours

Location: Troop A Command and Conference Call

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Lieutenant Tim Nichols #36, Lieutenant Seth Thompson #35, SFC Stephen Kennedy #754 and TFC Emilee Shackleford #875

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 01/22/2024

Time: 0241 Hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

On 1/22/2024, at approximately 0241 hours, TFC Shackleford was operating stationary RADAR on I-75 North near mile marker 327 when she observed a northbound vehicle coming up behind her at what appeared to be a high rate of speed. TFC Shackleford confirmed the vehicle's speed at 85 miles per hour in a posted 70 mile per hour zone. TFC Shackleford activated all of her emergency equipment and attempted to intercept the vehicle. The suspect failed to stop and a pursuit ensued.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☐ N/A

If needed, list: In addition to TFC Shackleford, Ringgold Police Officer Burgdon was involved in the pursuit.

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A

If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford contacted the Troop A Communications Center by radio and advised them that she was in a pursuit. TFC Shackleford provided her location, direction of travel and a description of the vehicle. Dispatcher Carden received this information and created a CAD call for the pursuit.

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A Explain: Once the pursuit initiated, Dispatcher Carden cleared the radios for emergency traffic before conducting a broadcast of the pursuit to all Troop A Troopers. Dispatcher McWhorter contacted the Whitfield County 911 Center while Dispatcher Carden contacted the Catoosa County 911 center to advise them of the pursuit and to request assistance.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: The pursuit initiated on I-75 near mile marker 327 and traveled northbound until the violator exited the interstate at GA 151. The violator turned right and traveled eastbound on GA 151 then turned right onto GA 3. The pursuit terminated at the intersection of GA 3 just north of Highland Drive when the violator crashed her vehicle.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes ☐ No If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The violator's actions during the pursuit support a charge of Felony Fleeing and Attempting to Elude.

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☐ No

If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford stated she experienced a rush of adrenalin during the pursuit.

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No

If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☐ N/A

Explain: Due to no other units in the area of the pursuit to assist in the deployment of Stop Sticks or utilizing the Box-In maneuver, TFC Shackleford made the decision to implement the Precision Immobilization Technique (PIT) on I-75 North at mile marker 339. However, the PIT attempt was unsuccessful and the pursuit continued northbound.

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A

Explain: TFC Shackleford utilized all her emergency equipment, exercised due caution throughout the pursuit and demonstrated good judgement/decision making skills. TFC Shackleford operated her patrol car in a responsible manner while commentating and communicating the violator's actions during the pursuit.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during nighttime hours with cloudy skies and a dry road surface. The traffic conditions on all roads traveled during the pursuit would be described as light.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: During the pursuit, the violator fled at high speeds and drove on the wrong side of the road. The violator failed to stop for red traffic signals and passed in no passing zones. The high-speed driving of the violator posed a great risk to the public while demonstrating no regard for the safety of others.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator complained of a back injury and was transported to Hamilton Medical Center where she was evaluated and released.

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The Suzuki and the Dodge both sustained minor damage as a result of the PIT attempt. The Suzuki sustained extensive damage as a result of the crash.

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford has been involved in numerous pursuits during her career as a Georgia State Trooper.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford has received E.V.O.C. and Advanced E.V.O.C. Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford utilized all her emergency equipment, exercised due caution throughout the pursuit and demonstrated good judgement/decision making skills. TFC Shackleford operated her patrol car in a responsible manner while commenting and communicating the violator's actions during the pursuit.

2. Areas for improvement.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Other considerations.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: At the conclusion of the pursuit, TFC Shackleford drew and presented her departmental issued TASER. Once the violator fled into a wooded area, TFC Shackleford secured her TASER and drew her service weapon while conducting a search of the area. A Use of Force Report was completed.

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.



N/A

If Yes, explain:

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36
Reviewing Officer

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

2/12/2024
Date